



BUILD BLOCK BRIEF · FALL 2026-27

Digital Business Lab **VENTURE LANE**

Planning brief session 4 · build from session 8 · 53 students · 11 teams · courses: GBCE691, GBCE692, GBEM693, GBEM694, GBET565, GBHR562, GEPG563, GBSM682

What your team is building

A digital venture or a digital transformation of a real firm, with analytics, neuromarketing, cross-cultural marketing, AI automation, e-commerce, HR and macro chapters; launched to real customers by session 12.

ONE PROJECT, SEVERAL GRADEBOOKS

You submit **one** piece of work, and each course that marks it looks at a different dimension, out of 20. **At most eight courses mark one team file.** A course you take that falls outside those eight sets you a **lens note** instead — an individual piece on the same project from that course's angle, 3,000 words, same rubric, same 20 marks. No student carries more than two: from a third, that course marks your viva out of 30 instead.

YOUR MARKS FROM THIS PROJECT

30 the project — a team mark of 20 from each course that marks your file, plus your own viva of 10, held in class in session 14

30 the mid-term

40 the final

The three quizzes are practice and carry no marks.

This replaces coursework, not classes.

What each course marks

CODE	COURSE	WHAT THIS COURSE MARKS — 20 MARKS
GBCE691	Business Analytics & Decision Making Usama Khalid	This course marks the analytics: whether the right question was asked, whether the data behind it can be trusted, whether the model or dashboard is correct and honestly scaled, and whether the team can show the decision the numbers drove. 20 marks, team.
GBCE692	Neuromarketing & Consumer Psychology Mohammad Mubashir Mussawar	This course marks the consumer evidence: whether the test asked a real question, whether the design and consent were sound, whether the analysis is honest about a small sample, and whether the change made to the offer actually follows from the result. 20 marks, team.
GBEM693	Global Marketing & Cross-Cultural Strategies Farhan Ahmed Shaikh	This course marks the market side: whether the segment was chosen from evidence rather than convenience, the clarity and defensibility of the positioning, whether the mix was adapted for a reason and the reason is stated, and how the cultural risk in the message was handled. 20 marks, team.



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GBEM694	AI and Automation in Marketing Usama Khalid	This course marks the machine: whether the stack works end to end from capture to conversion, whether the AI-produced content was verified before it went out, whether performance is measured honestly rather than flattered, and whether consent and privacy were handled properly. 20 marks, team.
GBET565	Emerging Trends & E Commerce in Digital Era Umer Naeem	This course marks the shipped thing and the plan behind it: the channel and model chosen for the SME, the storefront built with its checkout and fulfilment, the analytics instrumentation, the automation put in place, and the twelve-week growth plan costed. 20 marks, team.
GBHR562	Human Resource Management Shomayl Chowdry	This course marks the people side: whether the roles were derived from the work rather than guessed, the quality of the job descriptions and selection method, whether pay and benefits are lawful and affordable, and whether the people cost is carried honestly into the venture's numbers. 20 marks, team.
GEPI563	Pakistan & Global Economy Dr. Arifa Saeed	This course marks the economic case: whether the sector and demand read is supported by published data, whether the cost, pricing and exchange-rate exposure of the venture are correctly identified, and how honestly the evidence is used. 20 marks, team.
GBSM682	Strategic Management Usman Aleem	This course marks the strategy: whether the industry and competitor analysis is evidenced, whether the chosen position follows from it, whether the advantage claimed is real and durable, and whether the decision to persevere or change was made against a measure set in advance. 20 marks, team.

What to hand in

- **GBCE691 Business Analytics & Decision Making** — A live analytics view of the venture, built with AI tools and hosted — visits, conversion, cost per customer and margin on one screen — with the metric definitions written down, submitted by session 12 with AI declaration.
- **GBCE692 Neuromarketing & Consumer Psychology** — A tested and revised offer live on the venture's site by session 12 — the two variants, the consented test protocol, the participant record and the result — published with AI declaration.



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- **GBEM693 Global Marketing & Cross-Cultural Strategies** — A hosted landing page for the venture in two market variants, built with AI tools — positioning statement, adapted copy, pricing and channel for each — live by session 12 with the segment evidence and AI declaration.
- **GBEM694 AI and Automation in Marketing** — A working automation live on the venture's site and channels by session 12 — capture form, email or WhatsApp sequence, a chatbot and a CRM record — with the campaign content, the performance data and AI declaration.
- **GBET565 Emerging Trends & E Commerce in Digital Era** — A live storefront or site for the SME, built with AI tools and hosted, with working checkout, product data, analytics installed and at least one automation running, plus the growth plan — due session 12 with AI declaration.
- **GBHR562 Human Resource Management** — A hosted people pack for the venture, built with AI tools — organisation chart, job descriptions, a structured interview guide, a compliant offer letter template and a live people-cost model — submitted by session 12 with AI declaration.
- **GEPG563 Pakistan & Global Economy** — A live site or storefront for the SME, built with AI tools and hosted, by session 12, with a four-page economic environment brief — sector, demand, input costs, currency and policy exposure — and AI declaration.
- **GBSM682 Strategic Management** — A hosted one-page strategy brief for the venture, built with AI tools — industry analysis, chosen position, the advantage claimed and the measures that would falsify it — published alongside the live offer by session 12 with AI declaration.

How big the file is

The written file is **3,000 words for every member**, plus or minus ten per cent — 15,000 words for a team of five, 12,000 for four, 9,000 for three — plus the artefacts: the evidence or data log with its instrument, interview notes and consent log, any program with its tests, the pitch deck, the AI declaration and the draft-to-final revision log. In the venture and client lanes the live thing itself is the largest artefact. Each member owns one section of 3,000 words with their name on it, one artefact they built, and one part they can defend alone at viva. A lens note is 3,000 words on the same project. The full format is in "The Build Block File — required format" in the kit.



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Dates

Session 4	28 Sep	Planning brief issued — twenty minutes of class: the brief, the Ideas Book and the format sheet. Teams locked since session 3. Choose the project, design the instrument or find the client, split the sections.
Guest session	Session 4, 5 or 6	A practitioner from outside the university speaks to your school, on whichever of those three sessions the speaker can make. Attendance is compulsory. Each student writes one page on it for their own file; it is not marked.
Session 7	19 Oct	One-page plan uploaded to the portal: the question, the instrument or the client charter, who owns what. Not marked — it is the gate. This week the convener merges the marking courses' requirements into the file's sections, so the team writes one document and not eight. Clients matched to teams.
Session 8	2 Nov	Build starts. Rubric issued, roles confirmed, team charter uploaded. Build-with-AI workshop for venture and client teams.
Session 9	9 Nov	Scope agreed with the convener. Client or subject confirmed. Your school arranges its industrial visit for some point between now and session 12.
Session 11	23 Nov	Draft review, inside a normal class: each course teacher sees the teams in their own section for about ten minutes each — show what exists, not what you plan. The convener samples three files per block.
Session 12	30 Nov	The artefact goes live or reaches its first complete state.
Session 13	7 Dec	Final file uploaded with its AI declaration. Venture teams evidence the first paying customer. Five of the twenty come off for each week the file is late, in every course marking it, and nothing is accepted after the Karachi Review.
Session 14	14-19 Dec	Vivas in class: each course holds its own, team by team, in its session-14 class — about three minutes per student, on your own part as that course sees it.
The Karachi Review	Tue 15 Dec	Your team exhibits at its own table, across the campus, all day. The day opens with a thirty-minute handover of studies to the public bodies who asked for them; press and industry attend. Ten panels — a teacher and an alumnus each — circulate the exhibition and score you at your table, about eight minutes a team. Not marked separately; the panel sheet goes to every course marking the file.
Weekend	—	Weekend cohorts hold all of the above in their Saturday and Sunday slots; the Karachi Review runs on a weekend afternoon.

Rules for this lane



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What counts as done

A live offer that a stranger could buy from, and at least one paying customer who is not a relative or a classmate, evidenced by a receipt or transaction record with the customer's identity removed.

Money

The University funds each venture team with Rs 25,000; how to draw it is announced by the Office of the Provost before Session 8. Every rupee in and out is accounted for, with receipts, in the venture file; unspent funds are returned. You may also raise sponsorship on top. The University is not a party to your venture and carries no liability for it.

Legal ground

No company is registered at this stage. You operate as a sole-proprietor offer, payments go through one team member's personal mobile wallet, and the University is not a party to your venture and carries no liability for it. You may not contract in the University's name.

Sign-off

Food, health, cosmetic and childcare offers need your course teacher's written approval before anything is offered for sale.

Marks

Your mark does not depend on how much you sell. It depends on the evidence behind the gap, the quality of what you built, what the market told you, and the honesty of your post-mortem. A venture that fails and is analysed well can earn full marks.

Using AI

You are expected to use Claude and similar tools — to research, to build, to draft, to model numbers. Three rules. Check everything a tool gives you before you use it, and record the check. Declare what you used in the AI declaration bound into the file, as the HEC *Framework on the Use of Generative AI Tools* (2026) requires. Be able to explain, at the viva, everything your team built. **Work you cannot explain is not credited to you.** Undeclared use, or use to fabricate data, references or results, is academic misconduct. Never put real client, patient or examinee data, or anything identifying a real person, into a tool.

BLOCK CONVENER

PROGRAMME HEAD

DATE ISSUED